Troubleshooting Methodology

Objectives:

At the end of this episode, I will be able to:

1. Identify steps to the CompTIA troubleshooting model.

Exam Objective: *4.1 - Explain the troubleshooting theory and methodology.*

Description: In this episode, the viewer will identify steps and procedures to the CompTIA troubleshooting model.

- Identify the problem and determine the scope.
  - Question users/stakeholders and identify changes to the server/environment.
  - Collect additional documentation/logs.
  - If possible, replicate the problem as appropriate.
  - If possible, perform backups before making changes.
  - Escalate, if necessary.
- Establish a theory of probable cause (question the obvious).
  - Determine whether there is a common element or symptom causing multiple problems.
- Test the theory to determine the cause.
  - Once the theory is confirmed, determine the next steps to resolve the problem.
  - If the theory is not confirmed, establish a new theory.
- Establish a plan of action to resolve the problem.
  - Notify impacted users.
- Implement the solution or escalate.
  - Make one change at a time and test/confirm the change has resolved the problem.
  - If the problem is not resolved, reverse the change, if appropriate, and implement a new change.
- Verify full system functionality and, if applicable, implement preventive measures.
- Perform a root cause analysis.
- Document findings, actions, and outcomes throughout the process.

External Resources:

During this episode, you can reference the following external resources for supplementary tools and information:

- Not applicable if blank